



CONTAINMENT

AUTHORITY VS. RUIN

SECURE // CONTAIN //

PRESERVE

RELEASE // EXPLOIT //

TRANSCEND



01 ORIENTATION

WHAT IS CONTAINMENT

A two-deck head-to-head card game about a shared crisis neither player can fully control. **Authority** builds infrastructure, studies what it captures, and tries to keep the lid on. **Ruin** wants the lid off.

Authority wants to build infrastructure, Suppress threats, convert dangerous Anomalies into Contained value, and prevent the shared Breach Track from reaching catastrophe. Ruin wants to make containment unreliable, sacrifice expendable Personnel, raise Breach deliberately, and Release the very Anomalies Authority worked to secure.

Both sides share one Breach Track. Every escalation is a resource both players are spending from the same account — which is what makes the game a fight over a shared clock, not two separate solitaire piles.

AUTHORITY

Control / midrange. Wins by stabilizing the board and out-lasting Ruin's escalation.

RUIN

Aggressive risk/release. Wins by pushing Breach into windows only it can exploit.

AT A GLANCE

2 players • 60-card starter decks (15-card competitive side deck) • 20 starting Stability • 7-card opening hand, 7-card max hand size • shared Breach Track, 0-10



02 SETUP & TURN ORDER

OBJECTIVE & SETUP

DESIGN NOTE

The v0.1 design draft doesn't yet codify an exact loss condition. The strongest candidate, based on how Stability is spent and restored throughout the card pool, is: **a player is defeated when their Stability reaches 0**. Treat this as a working assumption to confirm during playtesting, not settled rules text.

Before the first turn:

#	STEP
1	Each player shuffles their 60-card deck.
2	Set both players' Stability to 20.
3	Set the shared Breach Track to 0.
4	Each player draws a 7-card opening hand.
5	Decide who takes the first turn.

Every turn moves through the same seven phases:

1. REFRESH Ready your Exhausted Personnel and Facilities.	2. BREACH Resolve any effects tied to the current Breach band, including a Catastrophic Breach at 10.	3. DRAW Draw a card.	4. MAIN Deploy Personnel, Facilities, Equipment; play Protocols/Responses.	5. COMBAT Attack with Ready Personnel/Anomalies.	6. SECOND MAIN Play anything left in hand you can still afford.	7. END Discard down to your maximum hand size of 7 if needed.
--	--	---	---	---	--	--



03 THE BREACH TRACK

A CLOCK BOTH PLAYERS WIND

One shared 0-10 track. Both decks have ways to push it up or pull it back — what happens at each band changes who benefits from the current state of the board.



AT BREACH 10 — CATASTROPHIC BREACH
Each player loses 2 Stability. All Contained Anomalies are Released. Each player Exhausts one Ready Facility. Breach then resets to 5.

Several cards key their abilities directly to these bands. A **Danger**-labeled ability triggers while Breach is 5 or higher; a **Critical**-labeled ability triggers in the Critical band (Breach 7-9). Read a card's keyworded ability header against this track to know when it's live.



KEYWORDS & GLOSSARY

WORKING DEFINITIONS

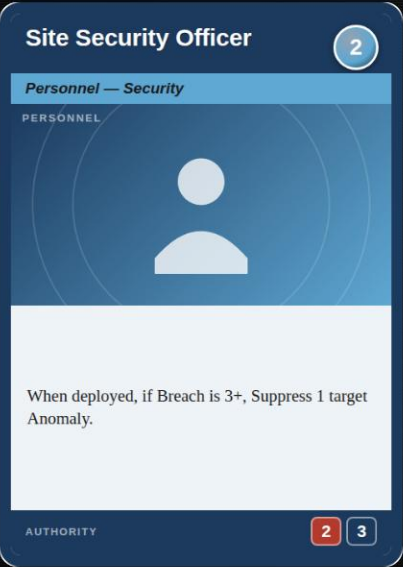
Derived from how these terms are actually used across both starter decks — not verbatim rules text from the design doc, which doesn't yet define them independently. Confirm and formalize wording during playtesting.

TERM	WORKING DEFINITION
Exhaust	Tap a card to pay an activated ability's cost, or force a target into that same tapped-down state so it can't act. Written both as a cost ("Exhaust: ...") and as an effect ("Exhaust target Anomaly").
Ready	The reverse of Exhaust — a card returns to an untapped, usable state and can attack, block, or activate again.
Suppress N / Suppressed	Apply N Suppression to an Anomaly, marking progress toward safely Containing it. Several Anomalies change behavior once Suppressed.
Contain / Contained	Move an Anomaly out of active play and into your control at a Containment Facility, usually gated by a Suppression threshold (e.g. "Contain — 3, while Suppressed").
Release / Released	The reverse of Contain — a Contained Anomaly re-enters play as an active threat, often raising Breach when it happens.
Threat N	A rating on Anomalies (2-5) used as a targeting restriction by other cards, e.g. "Exhaust target Anomaly with Threat 2 or less."
Capacity N	How many Anomalies a Containment Facility can hold Contained at once.
Stabilize N	Restore N Stability to yourself.
Sacrifice	Remove a card you control from play, usually as a cost, to trigger an effect.
Rapid Deployment	This card can attack the turn it's deployed, ignoring the usual summoning-sickness delay.
Guard	While this card is Ready, Contained Anomalies you control can't be Released by an opponent's effects.
Overwhelm	Appears on the largest Anomalies (Hollow Mass, THE THING BELOW). Wording alone doesn't fully specify the mechanic — treat as excess-damage-carries-over until formalized.
Clearance	A card-specific status (currently only on Black-Level Access Card) rather than a general keyword with its own independent rules.
Research	A persistent secondary resource that accumulates across turns and is spent by specific card effects.
Energy (typed)	The per-turn resource Facilities generate. Some is typed (Authority, Analysis, Ruin) — matching type likely matters for what it can pay for.
Danger / Critical	Ability headers keyed to the Breach Track: Danger triggers at Breach 5+, Critical triggers in the Critical band (Breach 7-9).
Catastrophe	An ability header tied to the aftermath of a Catastrophic Breach (Breach hitting 10), seen on THE THING BELOW.



05 CARD ANATOMY

READING A CARD



- 1 Name**
The card's unique title.
- 2 Cost**
Energy required to deploy or play it. Facilities show — (no cost).
- 3 Type line**
Category and subtype — e.g. Personnel — Security. “Unique” means only one copy of that exact card can be in play per player.
- 4 Category icon**
Quick visual read on card type: Personnel, Facility, Equipment, Protocol, or Anomaly.
- 5 Rules text**
What the card actually does, written in plain language plus keywords from the glossary.
- 6 Power / Durability**
Attack strength / damage it can take before being destroyed. Facilities and Protocols don't have this.

Anomaly cards additionally show a **Threat rating** in place of a subtype (e.g. “Anomaly — Threat 3”) — the number other cards check when they target “Threat N or less.”

AUTHORITY

SECURE. CONTAIN. PRESERVE.

Control / midrange. Establish Personnel and Facilities, Suppress and Contain Anomalies, generate Research, and keep the shared Breach Track under control.

CATEGORY	COUNT
Personnel	20
Facilities	15
Equipment	7
Protocols	18
Total	60

SIGNATURE CARDS

DIRECTOR EVELYN VOSS
Anthem effect plus a card-draw
engine off Stabilizing.

**CHIEF CONTAINMENT OFFICER
HALE**
Guard locks down your Contained
Anomalies while Ready.

CONTAINMENT TEAM ALPHA-9
Big body that both Suppresses on
entry and rewards Containing.

SITE-WIDE LOCKDOWN
A board-wide reset button when Breach is spiraling.

07 FACTION DOSSIER

RUIN

RELEASE. EXPLOIT. TRANSCEND.

Aggressive risk/release. Sacrifice Personnel, escalate Breach, exploit Anomalies, sabotage containment, and turn Catastrophic Breaches into offensive windows.

CATEGORY	COUNT
Personnel	16
Anomalies	15
Facilities	13
Protocols	16
Total	60

SIGNATURE CARDS

THE UNNAMED WITNESS

A modal payoff that can Release, draw, or push Breach on entry.

SUBJECT ZERO

Locked behind Breach 7+, then punishes Authority for Containing anything.

THE THING BELOW

Gets cheaper as Breach climbs and comes back swinging after Catastrophe.

LET THEM OUT

Forces Catastrophic Breach on your terms, then rewards you for it.





QUICK REFERENCE

RULE	STANDARD
Deck size	60+ cards (starters are exactly 60)
Copy limit	Max 4 copies per card name, except Basic Facilities
Starting state	20 Stability · 7-card opening hand · Breach 0 · max hand size 7
Turn order	Refresh → Breach → Draw → Main → Combat → Second Main → End
Breach bands	0-2 Stable · 3-4 Unstable · 5-6 Danger · 7-9 Critical · 10 Catastrophic
Catastrophic Breach	Each player -2 Stability, Contained Anomalies Released, each Exhausts one Ready Facility, Breach resets to 5
Competitive side deck	15 cards

This is a design prototype. Costs, wording, and quantities are subject to playtesting. See DECKLISTS.md for the full card-by-card lists.

